

Fat elbow tomato SOUP with ginger and sherry vinegar

This soup originated when I was trying to create a dish without having many ingredients to work with. Consequently, it is **simple** and very fast. Lightly spiced tomatoes with pasta—you don't need much more than that.

¼ pound cioccirole or large elbow pasta
[125g]

1 large onion, chopped

3 tablespoons olive oil

1½ teaspoons minced fresh ginger

3 garlic cloves, minced

2 tablespoons unrefined cane sugar

1 tablespoon ground cumin

1 teaspoon paprika

1 teaspoon salt

⅛ teaspoon freshly ground pepper

2 tablespoons sherry vinegar or cider vinegar

1 can (32 ounces) crushed tomatoes
[900ml]

4 cups vegetable stock [1L]

Slivered fresh basil, for garnish

- 1. Cook** the pasta in a large pot of boiling salted water until barely tender and still slightly undercooked, 8 to 9 minutes. Drain the cooked pasta and run under cold water until completely cooled; drain well. Set aside in a bowl.
- 2.** In a soup pot, **cook** the onion in 1½ tablespoons of the olive oil over medium heat, stirring occasionally, until softened and slightly browned, 5 to 7 minutes. Add the ginger, garlic, sugar, cumin, and paprika. Cook, stirring often, 1 to 2 minutes. Season with the salt and pepper.
- 3. Stir** in the vinegar and cook until it evaporates and the onion mixture is thick, 1 to 2 minutes. Add the tomatoes and stir to mix all the ingredients thoroughly. Add the stock and bring to a simmer. Simmer, uncovered, for 10 to 15 minutes.

4. Add the pasta and cook, stirring occasionally, until heated through and tender, 3 to 5 minutes. **Stir** in the remaining 1½ tablespoons oil. Season again with additional salt and pepper and a splash of vinegar, if desired. If you have time, let the soup stand for about an hour to let the flavors fully develop; then reheat. Garnish with basil before serving.

SERVES 8 TO 10

